and well-integrated into British society. In fact Anthony Julius notes that antisemitism faded from political consciousness in Britain in the 1970s precisely because of a sense that the Jews could look after themselves following Israel's victory in the Six-Day War.[46] At the same time anti-racists became concerned with the Far Right's hostile response to Afro-Caribbean and Asian immigration to Britain.[47] British anti-racists today are preoccupied with Islamophobia and anti-Roma racism to the exclusion of antisemitism.[48]

So for whatever reason, the Liberal Democrat Leadership did not see, or did not choose to see, Ward's Holocaust inversion as antisemitic. But what about the fact that the Jewish community *said* it was antisemitic? Should *this* not have been enough for the Party Leadership to treat it as such and to discipline Ward accordingly? It is worth noting that the 2006 *Parliamentary Report* recommended that the test for antisemitism should be subjective. Citing the Macpherson Report's view that a racist act is defined by its victim, the Report said: "We conclude that it is the Jewish community itself that is best qualified to determine what does and does not constitute anti-Semitism."[49]

There are three possible explanations as to why the Liberal Democrat Leadership did not listen to the Jewish community when it said that David Ward's Holocaust inversion was "antisemitic." First, according to sociologist Robert Fine, the British tendency to regard antisemitism as something that happened in the past means that people who claim they are victims of it in the present are regarded as either mistaken, over-sensitive, deluded, or worst of all—dishonest.[50] This is what David Ward himself thought. As well as accusing those who criticised his Holocaust inversion of acting dishonestly to prevent him from criticising Israel, he also accused those who criticised his July 2014 Gaza rocket tweet of a "jump straight on the anti-Semitism bandwagon."[51] Second, Fine also believes that those who raise concerns about contemporary antisemitism in Britain are regarded as inherently conservative and reactionary and they are ignored for this reason. It is as if the supporters of Israel and the "purveyors of antisemitism" are regarded as the enemy of all universal principles. This draws on an old tradition of anti-Jewish stereotyping which regards Jews as the "particularised people par excellence."[52] Third, there is a long tradition in British antisemitism that the Jew may be wounded with impunity and treated with contempt.[53] This traditional British attitude to Jews may have informed a subconscious indifference to Jewish complaints of antisemitism among the Liberal Democrat Leadership.

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